

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Employee Leave Management System

Portfolio Project 1
Business Systems Analysis Training Program
Prepared by: Muhammad Hamza
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1. Document Control

Field	Details
Document Title	Business Requirements Document — Employee Leave Management System
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Author	Muhammad Hamza
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Reviewed By	TBD
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1.1 Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
0.1	April 2026	Muhammad Hamza	Initial draft — project overview and stakeholder register
1.0	April 2026	Muhammad Hamza	Full BRD including gap analysis, user stories, and process maps

2. Executive Summary

This Business Requirements Document defines the requirements for the Employee Leave Management System (ELMS) — a digital platform to replace the manual, email-based leave request process currently in use.

The existing process requires employees to submit leave requests via email, managers to manually check leave balances on a shared spreadsheet, and HR to update records by hand. This results in approval delays of 2 to 3 days, frequent payroll errors, no audit trail, and significant administrative burden across the organisation.

The proposed system will automate submission, approval, balance tracking, and payroll notification — reducing approval time to same-day and eliminating manual spreadsheet dependency. This document provides the complete requirements baseline for Version 1 of the system.

3. Business Objectives

The following objectives define what success looks like for this project:

Objective	Success Criterion	Measurement
Reduce leave approval time	Approval time reduced from 2-3 days to same-day	Average approval time measured post-go-live
Eliminate manual spreadsheet dependency	Zero manual spreadsheet updates for leave tracking	HR administrator survey at 30 days post-launch
Improve payroll accuracy	Payroll errors related to leave reduced by 90%	Payroll error reports compared month-on-month
Provide employee visibility	Employees can view leave balance and request status at any time	User acceptance testing sign-off
Ensure rejection transparency	100% of rejections include a documented reason	System audit report post-launch

4. Project Scope

In Scope — Version 1	Out of Scope — Version 1
Digital leave request submission by employees	Payroll system integration (Version 2)
Automated leave balance tracking in centralised database	Audit trail and compliance reporting (Version 2)
Instant manager notification and approval interface	Mobile application
Mandatory rejection reason enforcement	Integration with third-party HR platforms
Automatic payroll notification on approval	Self-service leave policy configuration

Note: GAP-06 (Audit Trail) is documented in this BRD and scoped for Version 2. The database architecture for Version 1 shall support audit logging to ensure Version 2 delivery is not blocked by technical debt.

5. Stakeholder Register

The following stakeholders have been identified for this project. Full engagement strategies are documented in the Stakeholder Register (D2).

Stakeholder	Role	Interest	Grid Position	Attitude
HR Director	Project Sponsor	System reduces manual workload and compliance risk	Manage Closely	Supportive
Line Managers	Primary Approvers	Instant notifications and simple approval interface	Manage Closely	Supportive

Stakeholder	Role	Interest	Grid Position	Attitude
Employees	End Users	Fast submission and visible leave balance	Keep Informed	Supportive
HR Administrator	Data Owner	Automated balance updates replacing spreadsheet	Manage Closely	Resistant
Payroll Team	Downstream User	Accurate, timely leave data for payroll processing	Keep Satisfied	Neutral
IT Department	Technical Delivery	Clear functional requirements and integration specs	Manage Closely	Neutral

6. Current State — As-Is Process

The current leave request process is entirely manual and email-based. The following pain points were identified through stakeholder analysis and process mapping (see D3 — As-Is Process Map):

- Employees submit leave requests by email with no submission confirmation or reference number
- Managers must manually check a shared HR spreadsheet to verify leave balances before deciding
- Approval or rejection is communicated by reply email with no mandatory reason for rejection
- HR manually updates the spreadsheet after each decision — a single point of failure with no backup
- Payroll is notified of leave changes by a separate manual HR email, causing delays and omissions
- There is no audit trail — disputes cannot be resolved without searching email histories

Average end-to-end approval time under the current process: 2 to 3 business days.

7. Gap Analysis

The following gaps were identified between the current as-is state and the required to-be state. Each gap maps to one or more user stories in Section 8.

Gap ID	Area	As-Is Problem	To-Be Solution	Priority
GAP-01	Leave Submission	Employees submit requests by email with no confirmation or tracking	Digital form with instant confirmation and reference number	Must Have

Gap ID	Area	As-Is Problem	To-Be Solution	Priority
GAP-02	Manager Notification	Managers check email manually; delays of 2-3 days common	Instant system notification to manager with approve/reject interface	Must Have
GAP-03	Leave Balance Update	HR updates spreadsheet manually after each approval; error-prone	System auto-updates centralised database within 60 seconds of approval	Must Have
GAP-04	Payroll Notification	HR emails payroll manually; delays and omissions occur	System sends automatic notification to payroll on approval	Must Have
GAP-05	Rejection Reason	Managers reject by email with no reason required	System enforces mandatory rejection reason field before submission	Must Have
GAP-06	Audit Trail	No centralised record of leave history; compliance risk	Real-time audit log visible to HR Manager with filtering and export	Should Have — Version 2

8. User Stories

The following user stories define the functional requirements for the system from each stakeholder's perspective. All stories are derived directly from the gap analysis in Section 7.

Story ID	Actor	User Story	Gap
US-01	Employee	As an Employee, I want to submit a leave request on a digital platform so that I can plan personal commitments without waiting days for a response.	GAP-01
US-02	Line Manager	As a Line Manager, I want to receive instant notification of a leave request and view the employee's leave balance so that I can respond immediately without checking separate systems.	GAP-02
US-03	HR Administrator	As an HR Administrator, I want the system to automatically update an employee's leave balance when a request is approved so that I do not have to update it manually on a spreadsheet.	GAP-03
US-04	Payroll Administrator	As a Payroll Administrator, I want the system to send me an automatic notification when leave is approved and update the payroll record so that I can process payroll accurately without waiting for manual updates from HR.	GAP-04

Story ID	Actor	User Story	Gap
US-05	Line Manager	As a Line Manager, I want the system to require me to enter a rejection reason before submitting a rejection so that employees clearly understand why their request was not approved.	GAP-05
US-06	HR Manager	As an HR Manager, I want the system to display a real-time audit trail of all leave activity across the company so that I can monitor compliance and resolve disputes accurately. [Version 2]	GAP-06

8.1 Acceptance Criteria

The following acceptance criteria define the conditions that must be met for each user story to be considered complete and accepted during User Acceptance Testing.

Story ID	Acceptance Criteria
US-01	1. Employee accesses leave request form from dashboard after login 2. Start/end date selection blocks overlapping approved leave 3. Submission generates email confirmation with reference number within 30 seconds 4. System displays estimated decision timeframe after submission
US-02	1. Manager receives system notification within 5 minutes of submission 2. Manager dashboard shows approve/reject options and employee leave balance 3. System blocks rejection submission if reason field is empty
US-03	1. Centralised database tracks each employee leave balance in real time 2. Balance updates automatically within 60 seconds of manager approval 3. HR interface reflects updated balance immediately
US-04	1. Payroll Administrator receives notification with employee name, dates, and leave type within 5 minutes of approval 2. Payroll record updates automatically from leave database on approval 3. Payroll Administrator can view and confirm updated payroll records via interface
US-05	1. System displays mandatory text field for rejection reason when reject is selected 2. System shows error and blocks submission if rejection reason field is empty 3. Employee receives rejection notification with reason within 20 seconds
US-06 (V2)	1. Interface displays real-time leave activity from central database 2. HR Manager can filter records by employee, month, and year 3. System provides downloadable report of filtered results

9. Non-Functional Requirements

The following non-functional requirements apply across all functional areas of the system:

Category	Requirement
Performance	System shall return page load and form responses within 3 seconds for up to 500 concurrent users under normal load
Availability	System shall be available 99.5% of the time during business hours (Monday to Friday, 7am to 7pm)
Security	Only authenticated users shall access the system; role-based access control shall restrict data visibility by role
Usability	90% of employees shall be able to submit a leave request within 2 minutes without prior training
Data Integrity	All leave balance updates shall be transactional — no partial updates shall be committed to the database

10. Assumptions and Constraints

#	Type	Description
A1	Assumption	All employees have access to a company email address and internet-connected device
A2	Assumption	Line managers are the sole approvers of leave requests for their direct reports
A3	Assumption	Current leave balances will be migrated from spreadsheets to the new database before go-live
A4	Assumption	The IT department will provide infrastructure support for system hosting
C1	Constraint	System must comply with applicable provincial privacy legislation for employee data
C2	Constraint	Payroll integration is deferred to Version 2 due to budget and timeline constraints
C3	Constraint	The system must be accessible via standard web browser without specialist software installation

11. Requirements Traceability

The following matrix traces each gap to its user story, acceptance criteria, and the deliverable in which it is documented. This ensures complete coverage and supports UAT planning.

Gap ID	User Story	Acceptance Criteria Count	Deliverable Reference	Priority
GAP-01	US-01	4	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Must Have
GAP-02	US-02	3	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Must Have

Gap ID	User Story	Acceptance Criteria Count	Deliverable Reference	Priority
GAP-03	US-03	3	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Must Have
GAP-04	US-04	3	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Must Have
GAP-05	US-05	3	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Must Have
GAP-06	US-06	3	D4 Gap Analysis, D5 User Stories	Should Have — V2

12. Sign-Off

The following stakeholders are required to review and approve this document before development commences. Approval confirms that the requirements are complete, accurate, and agreed upon.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
	HR Director (Project Sponsor)		
	IT Manager		
	HR Administrator		
Muhammad Hamza	Business Systems Analyst		April 2026

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